Ben Whiteside

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Personal statement

A motivated and engaging MEng Computer Science with AI student (starting September 2026) with strong experience teaching and coaching young people in both technical and creative subjects. I bring a calm, supportive and structured approach to online learning, helping students build confidence while developing real practical skills in coding, game development and digital tools. Through my work as a dinghy instructor, percussion tutor and IT experience placements, I've developed clear communication, patience, and the ability to adapt my teaching style to different learners. I'm passionate about making technology fun, accessible and exciting — from Python and Pygame to creative software — and I'm now looking to join FunTech as an online tutor where I can inspire students, deliver high-quality lessons, and help them progress in a positive, enjoyable learning environment.

Key Skills

Online teaching — confident leading remote sessions, keeping students engaged and supported

Adaptable communication — able to explain complex ideas clearly to different ages and abilities

Technical tutoring — Python (procedural & OOP), Pygame, JavaScript, C++, Unreal Engine basics

Digital tools — Photoshop, Premiere Pro, Word, Excel, PyCharm, Filmora

Patience & learner support — experienced working with children and young learners, adapting to individual needs

Lesson planning — able to structure sessions, set goals, and maintain a positive learning pace

Problem-solving — strong analytical mindset from Computer Science and real teaching scenarios

Creativity — game development experience in Roblox, Python and Pygame

Professionalism — reliable, organised, punctual, and confident managing groups online

Education

Studying MEng Computer Science at University of Surrey (from September): 2026-present:

Studying A Levels at The Sixth Form College Farnborough: 2024-2026:

- Maths – Predicted A
- Physics – Predicted B
- Computing – Predicted B

Calthorpe Park School GCSEs: 2019-2024:

- Computing – 7,
- Maths – 7,
- English Literature – 6,
- English Language – 4,
- Combined Science – 77,
- Interactive Media - 2 Merit,
- Business and Enterprise – 2 Merit.
- Drama – 5,

Work Experience

Dinghy instructor - The Andrew Simpson Centre (Charity), Reading. 2024-Present:

- Teaching children & Adults to sail & gain stages of RYA Youth / Adult Sailing Schemes,

- Instructing and leading Assistant Instructors when large groups,
- Planning informative, safe & fun sessions,
- Running water sport activity days; on-land & on-water activities; paddle sports, fire starting, shelter building, RYA Swim Safe Sessions,
- Being a responsible and authoritative figure to students,
- Mindful of how every student learns differently,
- Being punctual, and maximising learning time,
- Working together well with other sailing instructors, to get the best out of a session.

Assistant Dinghy instructor - The Andrew Simpson Centre (Charity), Reading. 2023-2024:

- Assisting Dinghy Instructors with running sessions:
- Coaching Students on the water, or off water to improve their sailing, and
- Providing as an example for students to watch

Work experience at National Farmers' Union Mutual, IT Job Experience week June 2025:

- Learnt essential skills, such as kanban boards for organisation & identifying cyber security threats.
- Led the winning team during the Bridge Building exercise - Teamwork & Leadership.

Lead Drummer - Legally Blonde the Musical (Calthorpe Park School) Summer 2023:

- Complex grade 8 level music.
- Playing as a part of a 23-piece band, accompanying the musical.
- Coaching people, not just inside of the band, to perform in time.

Percussion Tutor/Assistant - The Winchfield Project, Calthorpe Park School February 2023:

- Supervising and teaching music to local primary school children.
- https://www.winchfieldfestival.org/home/outreach-programme.html.

Lead Drummer - Oliver the Musical (Calthorpe Park School Production) Summer 2022:

- Playing as a part of a 15-piece band, accompanying the musical.

Hobbies & Interests

- Writing games inside Roblox, with close to 6000 visits to one of my games. Have created games using the library pygame, python. Driven to create engaging content to draw gamers in,
- Drummer of The Big Band at The Sixth Form College Farnborough,
- Keen mountain biker on weekends and in holidays,
- Ex Hart Swimming Club Member - County level swimmer,
- Ex Member of multiple bands at Calthorpe Park School: Jazz Band, Guitar band, Cèilidh band, Samba Band, Bell ringing,

Sailing Qualifications/Experience: 2018-present:

- Dinghy Instructor.
- Level 1-4 sailing,
- First Aid,
- Safe and Fun (Safeguarding RYA course),
- Advanced module including sailing with a spinnaker, and seamanship skills.
- Sailing club member,
- Progressing my skills in Dinghy Instructor teaching,

Drums: 2019-present:

- Distinction at grade 6(2023)
- Distinction at grade 8(2024)